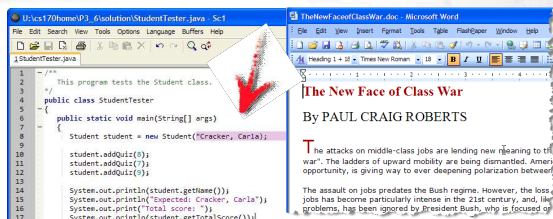


Introducing Text Editors

- Along with the JDK, you'll need a **text editor** to create the source code for your Java programs
- Like a word processor that uses plain text



Slide 1

Introducing Text Editors

Duration: 00:01:18

Advance mode: Auto

Notes:

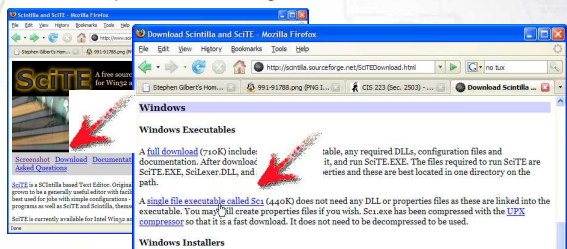
There's one last bit of preparation you'll need to do before you can write your own Java programs. In addition to the JDK, which you installed last week, you'll also need to install the software you'll use to create your Java programs. In this class we'll start out by using a text editor to create our programs, rather than an IDE like Eclipse or NetBeans..

A text editor is a little bit like a word processor--say Microsoft Word or WordPad--but without all of the formatting options; its documents are saved as plain text files. While you can tell your word processor to save as plain text, it's easy to forget to do that and end up with files that can't be used. Most of you are probably familiar with Windows Notepad program, which is a simple text editor.

Programmers' text editors though, are much more sophisticated than Notepad, since they were designed specifically for writing code, which is what we'll be doing in this class. The editors we'll use, for instance, actually understand the Java language, and are able to colorize your code, displaying misspelled keywords or missing quotes in different colors, making it easier for you to find your errors, like that shown in the picture here where I've forgotten the closing quote on a String literal.

SciTE

- The Scintilla Text Editor
 - Open-source, small, free, syntax highlighting
 - <http://www.scintilla.org/SciTE.html>



Slide 2

SciTE

Duration: 00:02:15

Advance mode: Auto

Notes:

If you already have a favorite code editor, (and I don't mean Notepad), then feel free to continue using it. Linux, for instance, comes with a half-dozen industrial-grade editors, including vi and emacs. Neither Windows nor the Mac include a programming editor as part of the included software.

For Windows users, I recommend the Scintilla Text Editor, or SciTE. SciTE is an extremely small open-source, free text editor that includes syntax highlighting (for JavaScript, HTML, CSS, and a variety of other languages) and the ability to launch your browser from within the text editor. We use SciTE in the Computing Center, where you can start it up by just typing Sc1.exe from the command-line.

The SciTE Web site is at <http://www.scintilla.org/SciTE.html>. (Be careful with the capital TE at the end of the name.) There, you'll find extensive documentation (so you can customize SciTE to your heart's content). To download the program, though, click the Download link shown in the picture, and you'll be taken to the download site hosted on SourceForge.

On the download site, scroll down to the Windows section, and download the single file executable called Sc1 by clicking the link in the picture. This is a very small file that is easy to stick on a USB thumb drive so you can carry it around with you. Save it on your desktop so that it's easy to

find when you need it. There's no installation needed.

There's also a version for Linux if you want to try it out. The link is on the downloads page.

To customize SciTE, you modify a plain text file named SciTEGlobal.properties. To try this out, just download my copy from the class Web site for this week, and place it in the same folder as Sc1.exe. To edit the file, choose Open Global Options File from the Options menu.

Notes:

SciTE is nice, but it doesn't run on the Mac. The most successful programmer's text editor in the Mac world is BBEdit created by BareBones software. The bad news is that BBEdit costs about \$185. The good news is that last year BareBones released a free programmer's text editor named TextWrangler2. TextWrangler doesn't do everything BBEdit does, but it's head and shoulders above any of the alternatives including TextEdit.

To get your copy head over to <http://www.bbedit.com/products/textwrangler> and click the download link. Save the disk image file on your desktop and double-click it to open the installer.

When the installer opens you just drag the TextWrangler icon to your Applications folder to install it and then run the program by opening your Application folder and double-clicking the new TextWrangler icon you find there. After you've installed the program, you can eject the disk-image file and throw it in the trash.



Slide 3

TextWrangler2

Duration: 00:01:11

Advance mode: Auto